

Changing the season theme rests on the hope of business improving if clothes reach stores hot off the ramp

By Nishat Bari

The Indian fashion scene may just be on the hemline of a major change. Lakme Fashion Week (LFW), one of India's biggest fashion events, decided to show Summer-Resort at a time when international fashion weeks are hosting Autumn-Winter collections. The change came after the organisers realised that many designers were showing summer collections at autumn-winter fashion weeks and saw great business potential in clothes reaching stores soon after the fashion show. Says Anil Chopra, adviser, Lakme, "It was the need to re-evaluate the business and be more responsive to the market needs. We are just reflecting the change in the market."

LFW's data shows that 95 per cent of the business generated at fashion weeks is from India and only 5 per cent or less is international. So it made sense to be driven by 95 per cent of the business. Colin McDowell, one of the world's top fashion commentators, says not conforming to international trends is not a problem, "International buyers travel across the world to hunt for good collections, so it doesn't matter if India does not follow those trends. Resort wear is globally very popular and London stores stock them as early as November." For now, LFW organisers are letting the figures do the talking. Out of a total of 154 registered buyer companies this season, 75

SHANTANU AND NIKHIL'S
SPORTY LOOK FOR
DEEPIKA PADUKONE

SUNEET VERMA'S
GRAND FINALE
LOOK DRIPPED
IN GLITZ AND
GLAMOUR

PRIA KATAARIA
PURI'S
SIGNATURE
FLUID
SILHOUETTES

SWAPNIL
SHINDE'S
FITTED
DRESS WITH
A NET BACK

Time to CHANGE